



Business intelligence

Business intelligence (BI) is an umbrella term referring to the variety of software applications companies use to access and analyze the massive amounts of raw data they have at their fingertips.

How it works

BI relies on software programs and computerized systems for collecting and integrating data in order that a business can report on its activities, both past and present. The tools allow staff to pull relevant data

from the company database. The marketer then views the information on a computer screen using a data visualization tool known as a dashboard, which can also be used for real-time monitoring of business operations.



NEED TO KNOW

- **Star schema** Simplest format of online analytical processing (OLAP) in data warehouse
- **Data quality (DQ)** Condition of company's master data, which should be complete and accurate
- **Slice and dice** Process in which large amounts of data are broken down to help analysis

Business intelligence process

BI tools allow retrieval of specific relevant data by specifying the terms of the intelligence they need (such as real-time sales compared to previous year's sales).

